Summary

- There are many third-party libraries available to help write less code when building your Django project. You can find many of them here: https://djangopackages.org/.
- The Django Debug Toolbar is an add-on that puts an overlay on top of your views to provide you with detailed information about the view's execution.
- The Debug Toolbar is divided into panels, each providing different information. Some key panels include execution time, SQL queries, HTTP request info, and profiling.
- The timing and SQL panels are key to solving slow page load times.
- Django Extensions is a collection of miscellaneous tools, including management commands, signals, fields, Models, and more.
- The `shell_plus` management command automatically loads key libraries into a Django-enabled REPL, saving you from having to do it yourself. You can even define what modules get loaded, including your own `Model` classes.
- Django Extensions comes with several Django fields and `Model` classes. For example, the `ActivatorModel` gets used to create objects that can be activated or deactivated, such as a blog page being published or not.
- Django Awl is another collection of useful tools. It also has additional `Model` classes, admin tools, view decorators, context processors, and commands as well as a custom test runner.
- Awl's `FancyModelAdmin` reduces the amount of boilerplate code you need when writing `ModelAdmin` classes and includes that ability to add columns in the Django Admin for related objects and those based on a rendered template.
- Django Awl comes with a replacement test runner, which has the handy feature of searching for a test using a shortcut to its name.
- Django Grappelli is a drop-in replacement for the Django Admin, providing a grid-based layout and a nicer look and feel.
- Crispy Forms is a collection of libraries that provide tools for writing better forms.
- Crispy Form template packs include HTML based on Bootstrap, Tailwind, and more, allowing you to build forms using the same styling as the rest of your site.
- A Crispy Form gets rendered with either the opinionated `| crispy` filter or the very flexible `{% crispy %}` template tag.
- Favicons are the small icons that your browser puts on the tab, showing the page's title.
- The favicon standard is messy, with lots of different files and sizes.
- Originally, favicons had to be served out of the root of the URL directory. You can accomplish this in Django using the built-in `RedirectView`.
- Feature flags allow you to conditionally expose a new feature to a subset of your site's visitors.